

Process-to-Agent Method

Ten steps from a real AP walkthrough to a promoted agent — with gates, not slogans.

The method

Step 1 — Observe

Sit with the processor. Record a real walkthrough of 5–8 invoices including at least one exception. The wall-chart SOP is a hypothesis.

Step 2 — Transcribe

Produce a speaker-attributed transcript. Store it in the enterprise tenant. Do not paste supplier tax IDs into a consumer model.

Step 3 — Extract

List steps, systems, decisions, rules, inputs, outputs, exceptions, controls, dependencies. If a decision has no owner, that is a finding.

Step 4 — Structure

One process map, one decision tree, coded exceptions, control map, RACI, SOP. Templates in / Templates.

Step 5 — Agentise

Mark each step: Human / Recommend / Prepare / Execute / Deterministic. Execute requires a written guardrail. Prefer deterministic for math.

Step 6 — Test

Replay historical cases. Write pass gates before you see scores. Include injection and entity-ambiguity cases.

Step 7 — Shadow

Live data, no action permissions. Log agreement, disagreement, and time-to-decision vs human.

Step 8 — Controlled pilot

One vendor group or one category, named users, kill criteria, time box.

Step 9 — Measure

Compare to the 90-day baseline. Controller present for financial claims.

Step 10 — Expand responsibility

A16 recommends; human owner decides; registry updated; access recertified.